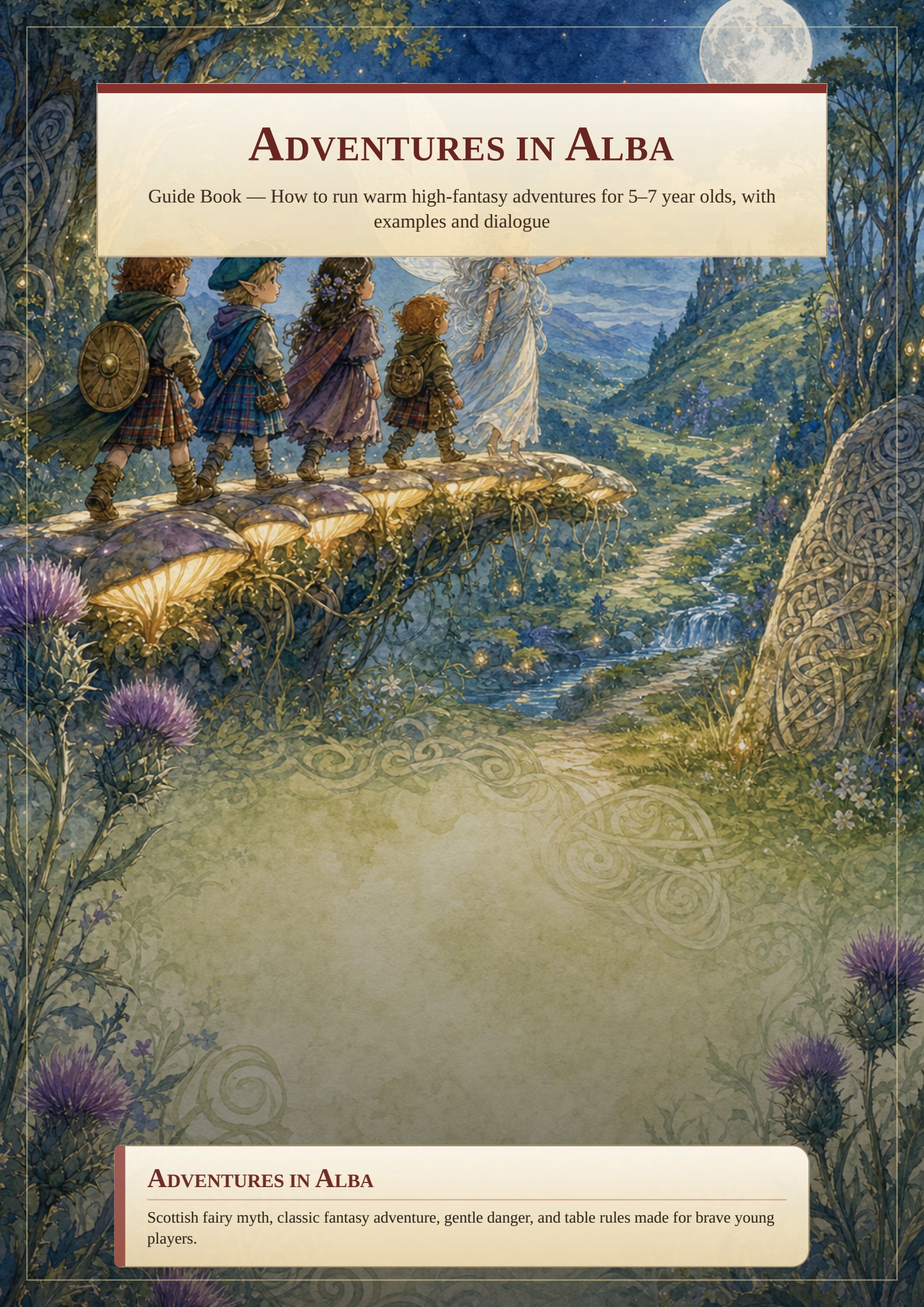


A whimsical illustration of four children and a fairy standing on a giant, glowing mushroom in a magical forest. The children are dressed in traditional Scottish kilts and a girl in a purple dress. The fairy has long, flowing white hair and wings. They are looking out over a lush landscape with a waterfall, a path, and a castle in the distance under a full moon. The scene is framed by a dark border with Celtic knotwork patterns.

# ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Guide Book — How to run warm high-fantasy adventures for 5–7 year olds, with examples and dialogue

## ADVENTURES IN ALBA

Scottish fairy myth, classic fantasy adventure, gentle danger, and table rules made for brave young players.



# YOUR JOB AS GUIDE

**T**he Guide is not the boss of fun. You describe the world, listen to children, ask what they try, and help the dice turn ideas into surprises.

- Use short scenes: 5 to 12 minutes each.
- Give choices in twos or threes, not long menus.
- Name feelings before fights: scared, proud, sleepy, lonely, worried.
- Let the children succeed often. The fun is in how it happens.



**Guide stance:** make every scene readable from the art, then support the child's idea.

**Safety tone:** no gore, no cruelty, no permanent harm. Trouble can be spooky, muddy, noisy, or puzzling.

## Useful phrases

- “Yes, and what does that look like?”
- “Who are you helping?”
- “Which stat fits your idea?”
- “That is a wobble, so something funny changes.”

### Guide rhythm

Picture → feeling → choice → roll only if exciting → warm change.

# SCENE RECIPE

## 1. A picture

Start with something children can see: misty bridge, silver fox, giant teacup, glowing thistle.

## 2. A feeling

Pick one: worried, excited, lonely, sleepy, proud, grumpy, curious.

## 3. A choice

Offer two helpful directions: follow the bells or talk to the fox.

## 4. A roll

Only roll if the answer is exciting. Use Strength, Int, Agility, Wis, or Luck.

## 5. A change

After each scene, something should be different: a clue, friend, promise, opened path, or new question.

**Read aloud:** “The moon is caught in the loch like a silver coin. The kelpie foal stamps, worried and wet. What do you do?”





## CREATURES ARE CHARACTERS

A creature should usually want something before it blocks something. Children can help, trick, soothe, race, sing, or befriend it.



# RUNNING ROLLS AND WOBBLES

## Choosing the stat

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- Use **Strength** for lifting, climbing, holding, pushing, or protecting.
- Use **Int** for puzzles, plans, facts, reading runes, or clever tricks.
- Use **Agility** for speed, balance, dodging, sneaking, or catching.
- Use **Wis** for feelings, nature, animals, and noticing what matters.
- Use **Luck** for charms, surprises, fairy bargains, and last chances.

## Good wobbles

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- A hat blows away.
- The map gets wet.
- A bell rings and wakes someone.
- A helpful creature misunderstands.
- A path opens, but it is muddy.

**Never make a wobble mean “you did nothing.”**

Always move the story.



# BUILDING ADVENTURES

| Part   | Question                    | Example                                 |
|--------|-----------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Hook   | Who needs help?             | A fairy cannot find the right door.     |
| Path   | Where must heroes go?       | Across the heather bridge.              |
| Friend | Who can help?               | A shy fox with silver whiskers.         |
| Puzzle | What needs a clever choice? | Three bells ring, but only one is kind. |
| Ending | How is the glen warmer now? | The lost moon-bell is returned.         |

**Guide promise:** prepare situations, not answers. If the child invents a kind solution, let it matter.



# TINY TABLES

## What is strange here?

|   |                                    |
|---|------------------------------------|
| 1 | A thistle glows like a lantern.    |
| 2 | Footprints turn into tiny flowers. |
| 3 | A crow speaks only in compliments. |
| 4 | The bridge asks for a joke.        |
| 5 | A teacup storm rains indoors.      |
| 6 | A sleeping troll snores bubbles.   |

## What does the creature want?

|   |                    |
|---|--------------------|
| 1 | A snack.           |
| 2 | A song.            |
| 3 | Someone to listen. |
| 4 | A lost button.     |
| 5 | Help being brave.  |
| 6 | A promise kept.    |

## How can it enter a scene?

|   |                                              |
|---|----------------------------------------------|
| 1 | It blocks a path by accident.                |
| 2 | It is crying quietly.                        |
| 3 | It has the clue but misunderstands it.       |
| 4 | It challenges the heroes to a silly contest. |
| 5 | It asks for a promise.                       |
| 6 | It follows the heroes home.                  |

# SCENE DRESSING EXAMPLES

## What to put in a scene

- **One clear picture:** a bridge with mossy faces, a teacup storm, a silver fox in heather.
- **One sound:** bell, splash, snore, giggle, creak, whisper.
- **One feeling:** lonely, proud, worried, sleepy, curious, embarrassed.
- **One useful object:** rope, button, lantern, map, boot, key, ribbon.
- **One choice:** talk first or look closer; cross now or find a safer path.

**Example setup:** “Rain taps the old bridge. A carved face blinks under moss. A red ribbon is tied around the middle stone.”

## Dialogue starters

- Bridge: “I will not open for stomping feet. I open for polite ones.”
- Sprite: “I am not lost. I am doing royal path inspection.”
- Brownie: “Hold still! Those boots have clues on them!”
- Fox: “A clever child would notice the quiet puddle, and you look very clever.”
- Owl: “Young acorn, I remember the path. I forgot the name of remembering.”

**Ask the players:** “What do you say back?” “Who helps?” “Which stat fits your idea?”



# RUNNING DIALOGUE WITH YOUNG PLAYERS

## Offer two tones

“Do you ask gently, make a joke, or stand tall?”  
Children often answer faster when the choices are emotional.

## Repeat their idea proudly

Adventurer: “I give it a biscuit.” Guide: “Excellent. You offer the dragon a biscuit like a peace treaty.”

## Make NPCs want something

Every speaker wants a snack, a promise, a name remembered, a path cleaned, a song, or help being brave.

## Let wobbles talk

On a wobble, the creature misunderstands: “You said boot? I thought you said flute!” Then the scene keeps moving.

**Mini example:** Guide: “The kelpie foal stamps, but its ears droop.” Player: “I talk quietly.” Guide: “That sounds like Wis. What do you say?” Player: “It is okay.” Guide: “Roll, and your friend may add +1 if they hum softly.”

# USING HP, MP, AND ENEMY DR

| Number | Guide meaning                                                   | Example                                                                |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| HP     | How long a creature can stay in a tense scene.                  | A troll with high HP can keep holding a log bridge while heroes help.  |
| MP     | How much fairy weirdness it can use.                            | A sprite spends MP to grow thistles or vanish in petals.               |
| Level  | How experienced or important it is.                             | A level 1 hare is a messenger; a level 4 hare might guard a moon gate. |
| DR     | Difficulty Rating: a quick “how big is this encounter?” number. | DR 1–2 easy, DR 3–4 fair, DR 5+ big scene or boss.                     |

**DR formula:**  $\text{round}((\text{HP} + \text{MP} + \text{Level} \times 3 + \text{positive stat bonuses} \times 2) \div 10)$ . Use it to pace scenes, not to punish players.

**Example:** Bog-Boot Brownie has HP 8, MP 3, Level 2, positive stats total 5.  $\text{DR} = \text{round}((8+3+6+10)/10) = 3$ .

# READY SCENE EXAMPLES

## Scene: The Bootprint Road

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**Read aloud:** “Golden bootprints glow in the mud. They walk in circles around a huge soggy boot. A muddy brownie waves a brush like a sword.”

- Ask: “Do you let it clean your boots, ask about the prints, or follow them?”
- Roll Wis to understand the brownie, Int to read the pattern, Agility to hop print to print.
- Wobble: the brownie cleans the map instead of the boots.

## Scene: The Star Sheep

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**Read aloud:** “A sheep made of cloud wool floats just above the hill. It bleats at a lonely star hiding behind a cloud.”

- Ask: “Do you sing, climb, shine a light, or ask what it lost?”
- Roll Luck for star magic, Wis for feelings, Strength to hold the kite-rope.
- Reward: the sheep makes a cloud bridge for one careful crossing.



# SCENARIO FROM THE GUIDE SIDE: BELL-ROOT PATH

## What the adventurers see

**Read aloud:** The path is moss-soft. Tiny bells hang from sleepy roots. A fox dreams beside a moon-rune door.

## What is really happening?

- The bells are an alarm, but also a puzzle.
- The fox is guarding the door because it lost the key.
- The silver acorn key is under the quietest root.

## Checks to offer

| Idea              | Stat     | Result                          |
|-------------------|----------|---------------------------------|
| Step around bells | Agility  | Reach the door quietly.         |
| Untie bells       | Int      | Learn which root hides the key. |
| Talk to fox       | Wis      | Fox admits it is worried.       |
| Hold branch       | Strength | Friend gets +1.                 |
| Lucky button      | Luck     | Find the quietest root.         |

**Wobble:** a bell rings, but it wakes the fox instead of starting a fight. Now dialogue begins.

# SCENARIO FROM THE GUIDE SIDE: BRAMBLE COMBAT

## Scene purpose

This is a combat scene that teaches danger without cruelty. The Bramble Sneak wants its shiny bell back and uses thorns to look bigger than it feels.

## Creature plan

- Round 1: block the path and shout.
- Round 2: use Thorn Tangle if adventurers rush.
- At half HP: admit the bell is important.
- At 0 HP: tangled, tired, and ready to bargain.

## Guide moves

| Move              | Use when                 | Safe result                       |
|-------------------|--------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Thorn Tangle      | A hero runs straight in. | 2 HP and stuck cloak.             |
| Shiny Distraction | Someone shows treasure.  | It pauses; next hero gets +1.     |
| Cap Snag          | On a wobble.             | Its cap catches and reveals fear. |

**End warm:** if adventurers return the bell, trade a button, or promise help, the Bramble Sneak becomes a grumpy shortcut guide.

# MORE READY DIALOGUE

## Gate with a voice

Read aloud: “The gate yawns. Password? it asks. Or snack-word. I accept both.” Use Int for clues, Luck for guessing, Wis for asking what it wants.

## Proud tiny ruler

Sprite: “I decree that all heroes must admire my crown.”  
Good replies include compliments, jokes, drawing a flag, or asking if the sprite is lonely.

## Helpful shopkeeper

Shopkeeper: “Copper buys rope, silver buys a kit, gold buys a favour, and mythral buys a legend. Spend kindly.”

## Creature at 0 HP

Do not narrate harm. Say: “The creature is tired, muddy, and ready to listen.” Then offer help, promise, snack, or rest.

**Scene loop example:** picture → feeling → choice → roll → wobble or success → new clue. Keep naming the next useful thing children can touch, ask, follow, or comfort.